

APRIL 13, 2026

eff.org

CLAW BACK YOUR PRIVACY

JOIN EFF



Hot Off the Press: EFF's Updated Guide to Tech at the US-Mexico Border

[ESPAÑOL](#)

When people see Customs & Border Protection's giant, tethered surveillance blimp flying 20 miles outside of Marfa, Texas, lots of them confuse it with an art installation. Elsewhere along the U.S.-Mexico border, surveillance towers get mistaken for cell-phone towers. And that traffic barrel? It's actually a camera. That piece of rusted litter? That's a camera too.

Today we are publishing a major update to our zine, "[Surveillance Technology at the U.S.-Mexico Border](#)," the first since the second Trump administration began. To help people identify the machinery of homeland security, we've added more models of surveillance towers, newly deployed military tech, and a gallery of disguised trail cams and automated license plate readers.

You can get this 40-page, full-color guide through [EFF's Shop](#) or download a Creative-Commons licensed version [here](#).

"The [Battalion Search and Rescue](#) always carries the Electronic Frontier Foundation's zine in our desert rig," says James Holeman, who founded the humanitarian group that looks for human remains in remote parts of New

Mexico and Arizona. "We're finding new surveillance all the time, and without a resource like that, we wouldn't know what the hell we're looking at."

The original version of the zine was distributed nearly exclusively to our allies in the borderlands—journalists, humanitarian aid workers, immigrant advocates—to help them better identify and report on the technology they discover on the ground. We only made a handful available in our online shop, and they went fast.

This time, we've printed enough for our broader EFF membership. Even if you don't live near the border, you can [support our work](#) uncovering how the U.S. Department of Homeland Security's technology threatens human rights by picking up a copy.

The zine is the culmination of a dozen trips to the border, where we hunted surveillance towers and other tech installations. We attended multiple border security conventions to collect promotional and technical materials directly from vendors. We filed public records requests, reviewed thousands of pages of docs, and analyzed satellite imagery of the entire 2,000-mile border several times over. Some of the images came from local allies, like geographer [Dugan Meyer](#) and [Borderlands Relief Collective](#), who continue to share valuable intelligence on the changing landscape of border surveillance.

The update is available in English, with an updated Spanish version expected later this year. In the meantime, we have reprinted the original Spanish edition.

If you want to know more, a collection of EFF's broader work on border technology is available [here](#). And if you're curious exactly where these technologies are located, you can check our ongoing [map](#).

SUPPORT THIS WORK



RELATED UPDATES



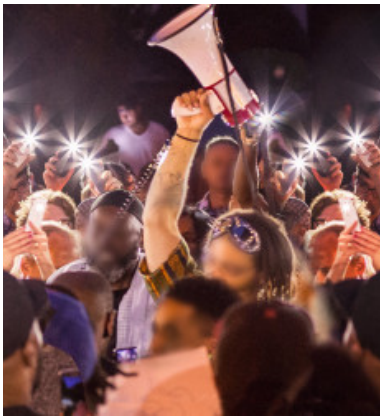
DEEPLINKS BLOG BY DAVE MAASS | APRIL 24, 2026

California Coastal Community Must Reject CBP's AI-Powered Surveillance Tower



PRESS RELEASE | FEBRUARY 10, 2026

Coalition Urges California to Revoke Permits for Federal License Plate Reader Surveillance



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY CINDY COHN | JANUARY 26, 2026

EFF Statement on ICE and CBP Violence



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY JOSH RICHMAN | JANUARY 15, 2026

Report: ICE Using Palantir Tool That Feeds On Medicaid Data



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY COOPER QUINTIN | JANUARY 7, 2026

ICE Is Going on a Surveillance Shopping Spree



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY DAVE MAASS, GUEST AUTHOR |
JANUARY 6, 2026

The Homeland Security Spending Trail: How to Follow the Money Through U.S. Government Databases



PRESS RELEASE | MARCH 31, 2025

EFF Installs Border Technology Exhibit at Angel Island Immigration Station



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY DAVE MAASS | DECEMBER 30, 2024

Exposing Surveillance at the U.S.- Mexico Border: 2024 Year in Review in Pictures

Customs & Border Protection Fails Baseline Privacy Requirements for



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY DAVE MAASS | DECEMBER 20, 2024

Surveillance Technology



DEEPLINKS BLOG BY DAVE MAASS | OCTOBER 21, 2024

U.S. Border Surveillance Towers Have Always Been Broken

ELECTRONIC FRONTIER FOUNDATION
eff.org
Creative Commons Attribution License